

Outdated Pages

Nothing is worse than having a site that has outdated content. Sites that contain content on the home page that was last updated over a couple of months ago are often considered ‘neglected’, and are ignored by visitors.

This holds true especially if you add a News section to your site and start updating it regularly, and then somewhere along the line, falter and stop updating it.

No Resizing

Web pages that cannot be resized are a big no-no. Often, people browse Web sites without maximising their windows. If half your content is not visible because your site does not allow for resizing windows, you have a problem on your hands. This also holds true for text resizing: nothing is more irritating than text on a page that visitors cannot increase or decrease the size of by using their browser’s text resize option.

Moving Text And Images

Let’s face it—scrolling text marquees are ugly! They are not considered good design any more, and you should avoid putting in scrolling text as far as possible. The only form in which scrolling text is acceptable is as a ticker on your site, such as a stock quote ticker, news ticker, or Shout box, where visitors can leave a message for other visitors. Basically, only if you need to dedicate a very limited space to content that changes rapidly, or is input by visitors, should you consider scrolling text.

Animated GIF images, too, are now considered amateurish. Most often, only jokes and ads contain GIF animation. Web users are accustomed to seeing GIF animations as advertisements, and have learnt to ignore them at sight. This means that all the effort you put into animating an image will be wasted on the majority of visitors. If you have to include moving pictures, make sure the animation is done well and flows smoothly, otherwise it’s likely that you’ll make your site look unprofessional.